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STARTUPS

Unicorn companies list & tracker

By [Jordan Rubio](#)

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PitchBook's unicorn tracker contains all new unicorn companies formed since the beginning of 2016. Explore trends in unicorn formation by filtering the chart below by time period or geography. Click on any bar to see the list of unicorns that were created in that period.

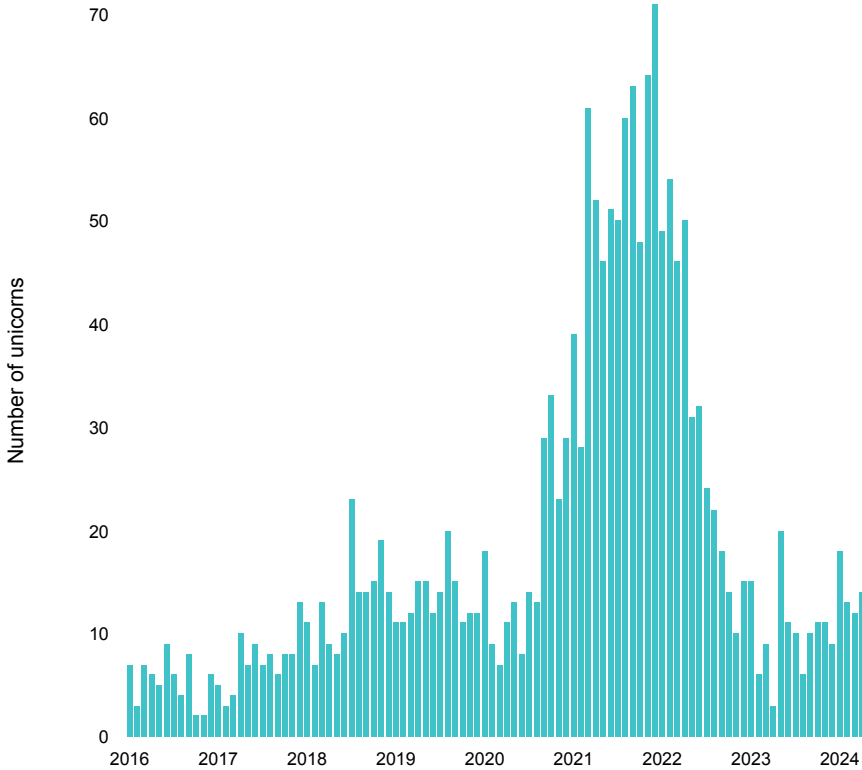
Unicorn creation over time

☒ Monthly ☐ Quarterly ☐

Annually Reset all
Click on a column to display the list of unicorns for that time period.

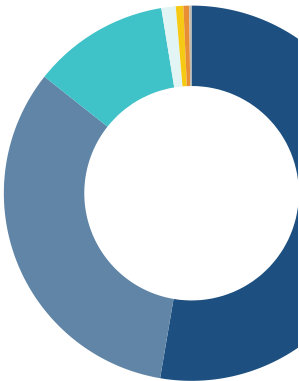
Filter by region.

Global

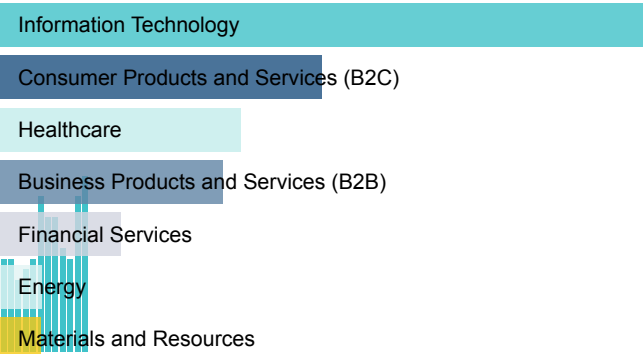


Regional breakdown

- North America
- Asia
- Europe
- Latam-Caribbean
- Middle East
- Oceania
- Africa



Top industries



Unicorn class of 2025

Company	Description	Most recent valuation	VC raised to date	Lead investors	Country
ANACONDA	Developer of a unified artificial intelligence(AI) platform designed to simplify, secure, and accelerate the use of open-source technologies.	\$1.5B	\$225.7M	BuildGroup, General Catalyst, Insight Partners (New York)	United States
MapLight	Operator of a biopharmaceutical company intended to focus on the discovery and development of novel treatments for debilitating brain disorders.	\$1.4B	\$665.2M	Forbion, Novo Holdings, The Goldman Sachs Group	United States
<u>CATL Intelligent</u>	Manufacturer of a skateboard chassis intended to advance innovation in new energy, automotive, and intelligent systems.	\$1.4B	N/A	-	China

	Developer of generative AI large language models designed to create enterprise-grade production models from their foundation.	\$1.0B	\$167.5M	DST Global, Nvidia, Radical Ventures, Snowflake	United States
<u>Erebor</u>	Operator of a bank intended to serve crypto clients and startups.	\$2.0B	\$250.0M	-	United States
	Operator of a fitness-based online platform designed to address preventive healthcare techniques.	\$1.6B	\$535.2M	Accel, Brookfield Oaktree Holdings, Chiratae Ventures, Eternal (Gurugram), Kalaari Capital, Temasek Holdings, Valecha Investments	India
THINKING MACHINES	Operator of an artificial intelligence research and product company intended to expand the understanding and customization of AI systems.	\$10.0B	\$2.0B	Andreessen Horowitz	United States
	Developer of an AI-powered software development platform intended to create software without coding.	\$1.8B	\$222.5M	Accel, Creandum, byFounders	United States

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What is a unicorn company?

The term unicorn usually describes **startups that are valued at more than \$1 billion**. But that definition has its pitfalls—after all, who decides what qualifies as a startup?

For that reason, PitchBook defines a unicorn more narrowly as a venture-backed company that raised a round at post-money valuation of \$1 billion or more. We stop considering the company a unicorn if it is no longer venture-backed because it goes public or is acquired, or if its valuation falls below the \$1 billion threshold—for example, because it went out of business or had a down round.

How many unicorn companies are there in the world?

Once a rare beast, [billion-dollar startups have become commonplace](#). More than 580 new unicorn companies were formed in 2021 alone, according to PitchBook data.

Globally, there were 1,509 active unicorns as of Aug. 1, 2025.

Why are startups called unicorns?

Venture capitalist Aileen Lee, the founder of [Cowboy Ventures](#), coined the term “unicorn” in 2013 to describe billion-dollar US software companies. At the time, these startups were both rare and special: Lee counted just 39 companies that met her criteria in 2013, a list that included [Facebook](#), [LinkedIn](#), [Workday](#) and [Twitter](#).

Why are these companies important? In venture capital, a small number of companies deliver most of a fund’s returns, a phenomenon known as the power law. Unicorns are a highly visible example of the power law in action.

What are the biggest unicorns in the world?

The top unicorns in the world—in terms of valuation—include [ByteDance](#), [Ant Group](#), Stripe and [SpaceX](#), according to PitchBook data.

Because the elite group of unicorns has become so large, some have argued that new terms are needed to describe them. The term decacorn is often used to describe startups with a valuation above \$10 billion. Axios’ Dan Primack, who helped to refine the meaning of unicorns, has made a case for the term “dragon” to describe private companies valued at \$12 billion or more, net of venture funding.

The valuations of the largest unicorns are especially vulnerable to the ups and downs of the stock markets. Facing a selloff of tech stocks in 2022, many of the most valuable tech startups are expected to struggle to maintain or increase recent valuations.

Which country has the most unicorns?

The US has the most active unicorns of any country with 729 companies, or 51.4% of the global total as of Dec. 2, 2024. Chinese unicorns are the second-most common at 313 companies, followed by India (61 unicorns), [UK \(48 unicorns\)](#), then Israel (27 unicorns).

How many companies become unicorns?

Unicorns are not exactly common, but they’re far from rare. In 2021, nearly 8% of all companies that received VC funding globally were valued at \$1 billion or more, according to PitchBook data.

The fact that so many funding rounds now involve billion-dollar companies is due in part to the growth in VC fund sizes. Several late-stage investors, most notably [SoftBank](#), have tech investment strategies built almost exclusively around backing companies that are

valued at more than \$1 billion. Due to increasing competition, however, some of these investors are moving into earlier stage deals with the hopes of building relationships with tomorrow’s unicorns.

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About [Jordan Rubio](#)

Jordan Rubio is a Seattle-based data visualizations editor at PitchBook. He previously worked at the Houston Chronicle as a data journalist and at the Victoria Advocate as a digital editor. A native of Jacksonville, Fla., Rubio graduated from TCU.

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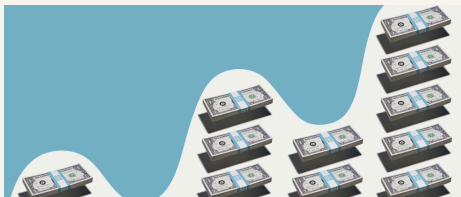


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